APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — GEOGRAPHY
Volume 3: Geography of Andhra Pradesh

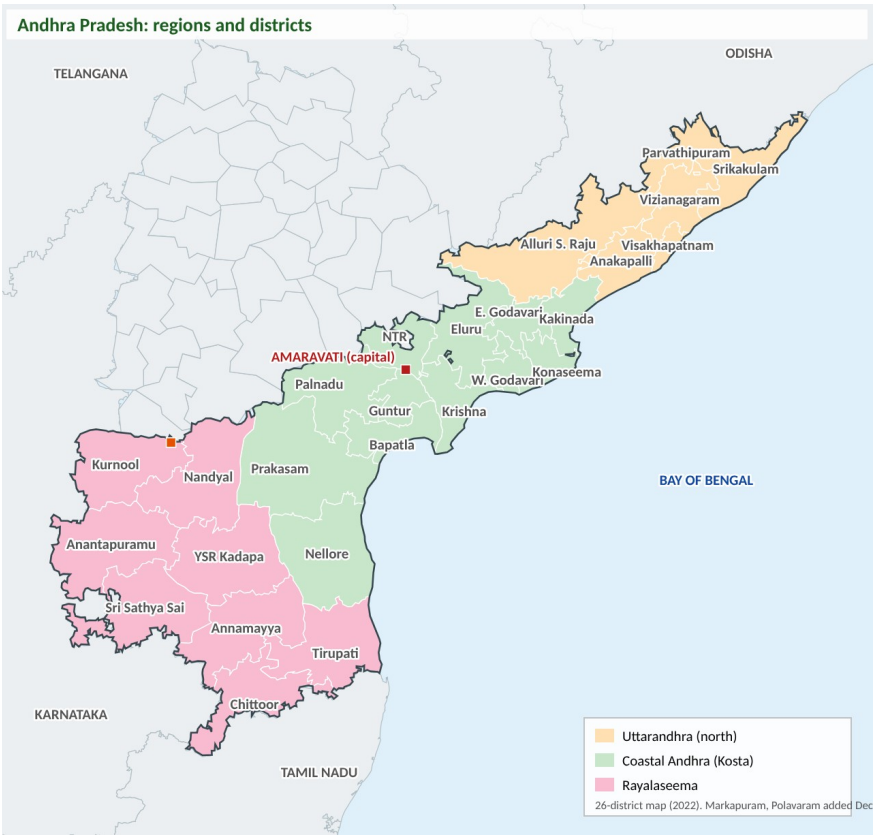
Location and Regions · Land, Rivers, Climate (recap) · Irrigation · Agriculture · Minerals and Energy · Industries and Ports · Transport · People and Tribes

READ THIS FIRST

How to use: same colours as Volumes 1-2: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Orange** = Kurnool / Rayalaseema link · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-check. Volume 2 gave the physical base of India and AP; this volume is **Andhra Pradesh only** and is the most scoring part of the Geography syllabus for you.
Study plan (5 days): Day 1 Ch 1-2 · Day 2 Ch 3 (water) · Day 3 Ch 4 (crops) · Day 4 Ch 5-6 (minerals, industry, ports) · Day 5 Ch 7-8 + final test.
Checked facts: districts (28 from 31 Dec 2025), SCoR railway zone (started 1 June 2026), Amaravati statutory capital (Act notified 7 April 2026), NSTR area (about 3,728 sq km), coastline (974 km, official AP figure). Items marked **(verify)** change often; recheck in the latest current affairs.

CHAPTER 1 — ANDHRA PRADESH: LOCATION, REGIONS AND DISTRICTS

The state in one page



Map 1.1 Regions and districts (26-district base map; Markapuram and Polavaram were added on 31 Dec 2025)

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Where: south-east India, between about **12.6°N–19.9°N** and **76.7°E–84.8°E**, entirely south of the Tropic of Cancer (so a **tropical** state). **Area about 1,62,970 sq km, about 7th largest state (verify). Coastline about 974 km, second longest after Gujarat** (the state's official figure; newer surveys differ).
Neighbours: Telangana (north-west), **Chhattisgarh and Odisha** (north), **Tamil Nadu** (south), **Karnataka** (west/south-west), **Bay of Bengal** (east). **Yanam** (Puducherry's enclave) lies inside the Godavari delta.
Capital: Amaravati, on the south bank of the **Krishna** near Vijayawada and Guntur. The **AP Reorganisation (Amendment) Act, 2026** (notified **7 April 2026**; deemed in force from 2 June 2024) names Amaravati the state's capital by law.
Three cultural regions: Uttarandhra (north: Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Visakhapatnam side, with the Eastern Ghats), **Coastal Andhra / Kosta** (Godavari, Krishna, Guntur and Prakasam deltas and plains), and **Rayalaseema** (south-west dry plateau).
Rayalaseema = 'land of the Rayas' (the name was adopted in 1928); the area was the **'Ceded Districts'** given by the Nizam to the British in 1800 (Kurnool, Kadapa, Anantapur, Bellary).

How the state was made (very important for the exam)

Year	Event
1 Oct 1953	**Andhra State** formed from Madras State (after Potti Sriramulu's fast unto death in 1952); **Kurnool** was its capital (1953-56); first CM **T. Prakasam**.
1 Nov 1956	**Andhra Pradesh** formed by merging Andhra State with the Telugu-speaking part of Hyderabad State (**States Reorganisation Act 1956**); capital **Hyderabad**.
2 Jun 2014	**AP Reorganisation Act, 2014**: **Telangana** carved out (10 districts); Hyderabad common capital for up to 10 years; special provisions (Polavaram as national project, etc.).
4 Apr 2022	**13 → 26 districts** (new districts such as Nandyal, Sri Sathya Sai, Annamayya, Tirupati, NTR, Konaseema).
31 Dec 2025	**Markapuram and Polavaram** formed → **28 districts**.

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool was the **capital of Andhra State (1953-56)**, so it appears in history, polity and geography questions. Today the old Kurnool district is split into **Kurnool** and **Nandyal** (2022); both are in **Rayalaseema**, a **semi-arid** region on the **Deccan plateau** with black cotton soil.
Kurnool town stands on the **Tungabhadra**, close to its confluence with the Krishna at **Sangameswaram**, and on **NH 44** (Srinagar–Kanyakumari highway). It is the 'gateway of Rayalaseema' on the Hyderabad–Bengaluru route.

EXAM TRAPS

Capital of Andhra State (1953) = **Kurnool**, not Hyderabad. Capital of AP now = **Amaravati**.
AP coastline = **974 km, second longest (Gujarat first)**.
Present districts = **28** (since 31 Dec 2025); many books still say 13 or 26.

2-MINUTE REVISION

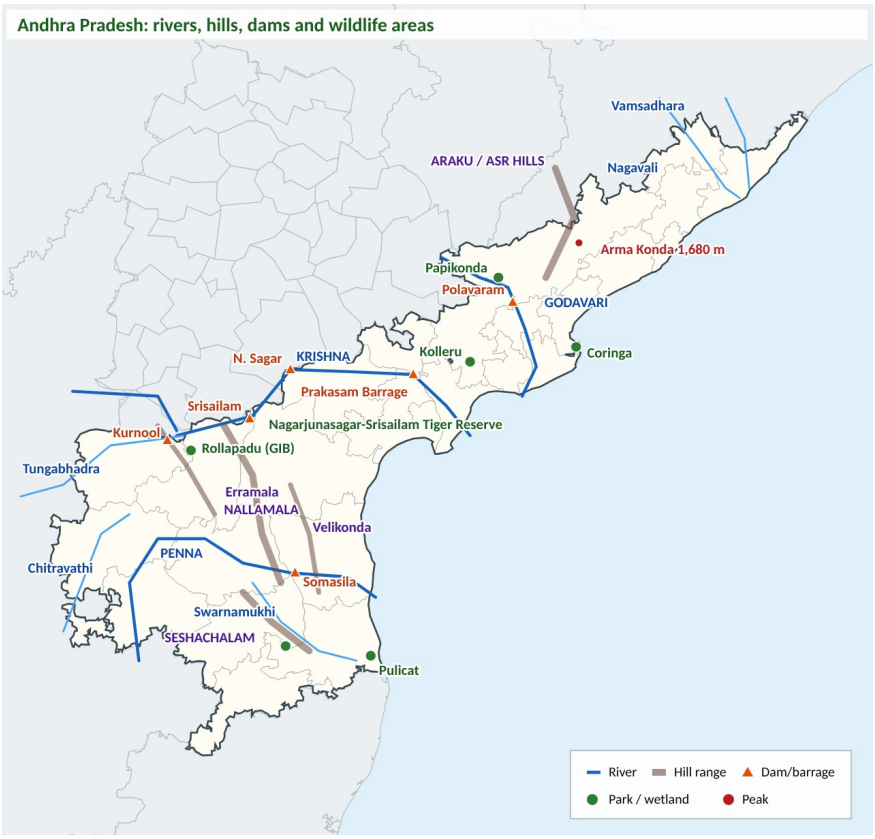
AP lies 12.6°-19.9°N; 7 neighbours/sides; coast 974 km (2nd).
Regions: Uttarandhra, Coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema.
Dates: 1 Oct 1953 → 1 Nov 1956 → 2 Jun 2014 → 4 Apr 2022 (26) → 31 Dec 2025 (28).

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. First capital of Andhra State: **Kurnool** · Q2. District count today: **28** · Q3. 'Ceded Districts' were given to the British by: **the Nizam (1800)**

CHAPTER 2 — LAND, RIVERS, CLIMATE, SOILS (AP RECAP)

Volume 2 gave the theory; here it is AP only



Map 2.1 Rivers, hills, dams and wildlife areas of AP (schematic)

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Three landform zones: (1) Eastern Ghats / hill region (north-east: **Araku, Alluri Sitarama Raju hills**; **Arma Konda 1,680 m** is the highest point of AP; central **Nallamala**; south **Seshachalam, Velikonda, Palkonda**). **(2) Rayalaseema plateau** (low, rocky, 200-600 m, with ranges like **Erramala**). **(3) Coastal plain** (wide, flat; **Godavari and Krishna deltas** are among India's finest rice lands).
Rivers: east-flowing, ending in the Bay of Bengal. **Big three: Godavari, Krishna, Penna. North coastal: Vamsadhara, Nagavali** (Eastern Ghats origin). **Tributary: Tungabhadra** (joins the Krishna near Kurnool). Most are **seasonal** except the Godavari and Krishna in their lower reaches.
Climate: tropical monsoon / savanna; summers very hot (40-45°C), **SW monsoon** (Jun-Sep) and an **important NE monsoon** (Oct-Dec) on the south and coastal belt; **cyclones in Oct-Nov**. **Rayalaseema** (Anantapur, Kurnool, Kadapa) lies in the **rain shadow** of the Western Ghats and is **semi-arid**, the driest region of AP.
Soils: red (most widespread), **black** (Kurnool, Anantapur, Guntur, Prakasam), **alluvial** (deltas), **laterite** (Eastern Ghats), **coastal sands and saline** soils. **Natural vegetation:** mostly **dry deciduous** and scrub; **mangroves at Coringa**; **Red Sanders** in the Seshachalam-Nallamala belt.

Wildlife area	Where	Why it matters
Nagarjunasagar-Srisailam Tiger Reserve (NSTR)	Nandyal, Palnadu, Prakasam (AP side) with Telangana's Amrabad	**Largest tiger reserve of India by area, about 3,728 sq km**; Krishna passes through it; Chenchu tribe homeland
Rollapadu WLS	Kurnool/Nandyal	**Great Indian Bustard** (critically endangered) and blackbuck
Coringa WLS	Kakinada (Godavari delta)	Mangroves, fishing cat, Godavari delta
Kolleru, Pulicat	Eluru; Tirupati-Nellore	Kolleru: **Ramsar** freshwater lake; **Pulicat**: second largest brackish lagoon (after Chilika)
Seshachalam Hills Biosphere Reserve	Tirupati-Kadapa	AP's only biosphere reserve; **Red Sanders**, endemic and heavily smuggled
Papikonda NP, Sri Venkateswara NP	Godavari gorge; Tirupati	Scenic gorge; Eastern Ghats forest

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool-Nandyal: the **Nallamala** hills (forest, tigers, **Chenchu** tribe) and the **Erramala** ridge frame the district; the **Krishna** (Srisailam) forms the north-east edge and the **Tungabhadra** the north. **Banaganapalle** (Nandyal) has the famous **Banganapalli mango** (GI tag) and **Belum Caves** (Kolimigundla) are one of the longest cave systems on the plains of the Indian subcontinent. **Rollapadu** protects the **Great Indian Bustard**.
Drought and heat: Rayalaseema gets **less than 600 mm** in many years and sees **heat waves**; **lightning** is a major cause of death in the monsoon (APSDMA issues SMS warnings).

2-MINUTE REVISION

Highest point Arma Konda 1,680 m. Rivers: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Tungabhadra (tributary), Vamsadhara, Nagavali.
NSTR largest tiger reserve (3,728 sq km). Seshachalam only biosphere reserve. Rollapadu = GIB.
Rayalaseema semi-arid; coast gets cyclones and NE monsoon.

CHAPTER 3 — WATER AND IRRIGATION IN ANDHRA PRADESH

AP is a state of canals in the east and tanks and lifts in the west

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Why irrigation matters here: monsoon rain is **erratic**, and Rayalaseema is semi-arid. So the state depends on **canals** (delta districts), **tanks** (old village ponds, Rayalaseema and Chittoor), **tube wells** and **lift schemes** (pumping water uphill).
The big idea of AP water policy: bring **flood water of the Godavari** (surplus) to the **Krishna** (deficit) and then to **Rayalaseema** (drought). That is why **Polavaram → Prakasam Barrage → Srisailam / Rayalaseema** is repeated in news.

Project	River / place	Key facts
Dowleswaram (Godavari) Barrage	Rajahmundry	**Sir Arthur Cotton** built the anicut (1850s); feeds the **Godavari delta**; Cotton is revered as the 'father of Godavari delta'.
Polavaram (Indira Sagar)	Godavari, Polavaram district	**National project** under the 2014 Reorganisation Act; multipurpose (irrigation, power, drinking water); right canal links to the Krishna. Delays and cost rises are in the news (verify status).
Pattiseema lift	Godavari → Krishna	Lifts Godavari water into the Polavaram right canal to reach the Krishna (completed 2016).
Prakasam Barrage	Krishna, Vijayawada	Built 1957 replacing the 1855 anicut; feeds the Krishna delta.
Nagarjuna Sagar	Krishna (AP-Telangana border)	One of the world's largest **masonry** dams; completed 1960s; left canal feeds Guntur-Prakasam.